

John Patterson

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Amsterdam, NL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Promoted to Engineering Manager within 9 months of joining Adyen, leading a 12+ person multidisciplinary team across multiple merchant-facing Customer Area products. In 18 months: led a C-suite compliance crisis, deprecated a platform with 0 operational burden, and turned around the reliability profile of two teams. Engineering career spanning Adyen, Stripe, Microsoft, and Qualtrics.

EXPERIENCE

Adyen

Oct '24 – Present

Engineering Manager

Amsterdam, NL

- Designed and drove end-to-end deprecation of the Balance Platform Customer Area. Partnered with Product, Design, and Ops to migrate all users with zero incremental operational or support burden.
- Led a confidential, high-stakes task force of 2 Data, 1 Staff, 3 BE, 1 FE to implement stronger privacy controls platform-wide under a tight compliance deadline of a week. Owned technical execution and liaised with C-suite, SVPs, Legal, Commercial, Security, and Comms.
- Managed two multidisciplinary teams totaling 12+ (6 BE, 5 FE, 4 PMs, 1 designer) across Customer Area merchant-facing products. Recruited and onboarded a Senior Engineer and three L2 engineers, while proactively managing underperformance and long-term sick leave cases.
- Orchestrated large-scale data-service migration from Postgres to Elasticsearch & Kafka. Led by coaching and empowering a Senior Engineer to own execution, cutting critical SLO slips from 12+ to zero.
- Re-engineered team delivery practices for two teams. Driving feature cycle time for User Guidance from 14 days to 3 days, stabilizing Key Journeys to <10 open bugs, and assuming ownership of the critical payments pages while maintaining +70% product goal KPIs.
- Organized a cross-organizational squad to deploy Gemini CLI across Adyen. Negotiated with Platform Engineering to onboard Sentry Cloud to support frontend monitoring flows.

Adyen

Jan '24 – Oct '24

Senior Software Engineer

Amsterdam, NL

- Backend Java/Spring engineer on the Balance Platform Customer Area, the platform, marketplace, and bank customer management portal.
- Used consumers and Elasticsearch to scale search and list operations for Adyen's largest platforms.
- Interviewed pilot customers and incorporated feedback for our new KYC performance insights tool.
- Mentored teammates in areas of engineering excellence like monitoring, testing, and documentation.
- Led team's SLO and reliability efforts. Includes work coordination, coaching, and presenting progress to leadership.

Relocation to the Netherlands

Oct '23 – Jan '24

Stripe

Jun '21 – Oct '23

Senior Software Engineer / Project Lead

Seattle, WA, USA

- Spent 1 year on Stripe's liquidity management team, ensuring cash is in the right account, in the right currency, at the right time. The primary tech used is Java, Spark, Flink, and Kafka.
- Led a crew of 3 engineers in building a service processing ~500 QPS.
- Designed our 2-year release roadmap, coordinating 3 engineering teams, product, and data science

- Develop Stripe's Brazilian Anticipations offering, collaborating closely with Legal, Product, Accounting, and over 10 other cross-functional teams. Included product scoping, service architecture, individual coding contributions, and leading other engineers on the project.
- Decreased team's KTLO through mentoring, dashboarding, and better runbooks. Our active weekly backlog went from ~80 bugs to <10.
- Worked on the design of new core, user-facing Stripe APIs.

Microsoft

April '18 – Jun '21

Senior Software Engineer / Squad Lead

Redmond, WA, USA

- Led a squad of 5 engineers writing a compiler for Office test spec validation. Duties included: holding 1:1's, project management, peer development, liaising with partner teams and customers, and personal software contributions.
- Redesigned C# build tool, shaving 44% off build times.
- Improved caching, tripling system capacity (\$3m+ savings), and eliminating most common errors.
- Worked on an automation platform in C# which 1,700 engineers used to run 10m jobs daily.

Qualtrics

June '17 – April '18

Software Engineer

Seattle, WA, USA

- Converted an organization of 30+ engineers to use TypeScript.
(My article on this process: <https://www.qualtrics.com/eng/typescript-refactor>)
- Automated code coverage reporting with TypeScript for 10 teams, saving 120 dev-days/yr.
- Used JavaScript, TypeScript, and Python to write an Angular E2E framework serving 800 engineers.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines with Maven, Docker, Jenkins, and Rundeck.

Acadian Ambulance

Jan. '16 – May '17

Software Engineer

Lafayette, LA, USA

- Used Clojure to create a team debugging portal and automate its deployment of new instances.
- Taught my team F#, then used it to create a 125-form medical billing application.

Golfballs.com

May '14 – Dec '15

Software Engineer Intern

Lafayette, LA, USA

- Used VB.NET and MS-SQL to work on core business ASP.NET website backed by AWS.
- Built a new product end-to-end with work across the website, warehouse, and production.

University of Louisiana at Lafayette

May '14 – July '14

Software Engineer Intern

Lafayette, LA, USA

- Developed software and coursework for teaching Python to students using robotics.

EDUCATION

University of Louisiana at Lafayette

May '12 – May '16

B.S. Computer Science

3.94 / 4.00 GPA

B.S. Mathematics

Lafayette, LA, USA

- Math Society President for 3 years
- 2016's Outstanding Graduate for the College of Sciences
- Coursework: Operating Systems, Programming Languages, Databases, AI, Topology, Abstract Algebra